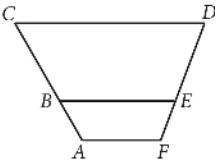


Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Geometry and Trigonometry	Lines, angles, and triangles	Medium

Question



In the figure above, $\overline{AF}$, $\overline{BE}$, and $\overline{CD}$ are parallel. Points B and E lie on $\overline{AC}$ and $\overline{FD}$, respectively. If $AB = 9$, $BC = 18.5$, and $FE = 8.5$, what is the length of $\overline{ED}$, to the nearest tenth?

Answer

- A. 16.8
- B. 17.5
- C. 18.4
- D. 19.6

Correct Answer: B

Rationale

Choice B is correct. Since $\overline{AF}$, $\overline{BE}$, and $\overline{CD}$ are parallel, quadrilaterals $AFEB$ and $BEDC$ are similar. Let x represent the length of $\overline{ED}$. With similar figures, the ratios of the lengths of corresponding sides are equal. It follows that $\frac{9}{18.5} = \frac{8.5}{x}$. Multiplying both sides of this equation by 18.5 and by x yields $9x = (18.5)(8.5)$, or $9x = 157.25$. Dividing both sides of this equation by 9 yields $x = 17.47$, which to the nearest tenth is 17.5.

Choices A, C, and D are incorrect and may result from errors made when setting up the proportion.